

PHP and databases

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PHP has become widely popular due to its capacity to use varied and powerful database systems. Website content is made dynamic, interactive and flexible with the help of a database.

Databases are collection of data, stored separately in such a manner that you can easily recover it. Database information is stored in table format. The tables are divided into rows and columns, separating the data uniformly. Each row in a table represents a single record like name and address. In each column of a table, a uniform record is maintained like the first name of an individual and his/her contact number. A database in such format arranges a record according to the values available in the column exactly like a spreadsheet program.

In this way, you can easily retrieve a record from a database without keeping in mind how the data has been arranged into a table. Basically, most of the database systems use the SQL. There are several Database Management Systems available in the Market. Mysql, Microsoft SQL Server, Oracle are among others. MySQL is the most popular Open Source Database Management System and for this 'Open Source' nature it is widely used among the web applications that use PHP.

PHP performs various inbuilt functions with certain databases such as MySQL database, SQL Server, Oracle and others. PHP supports databases in multiple ways. It supports various databases as:

- Informix
- DBM (Berkeley)
- MSSQL (Microsoft)
- Sybase
- Oracle 8
- PostgreSQL (Berkeley, open source)
- MySQL (Open source)